Your Puppy's First Week

The checklist from Puppy's First 30 Days

Print this out and stick it on the fridge. Tick things off as you go, and don't worry about doing it all in order — the first week is messy, and the list is just there so nothing important slips past while you're running on very little sleep.

Before the puppy arrives

- ☐ Crate with divider, set up in your bedroom
- ☐ Food, the exact kind the puppy already eats
- ☐ Two stainless steel bowls
- ☐ Flat collar with a tag that has your phone number
- ☐ Six-foot leash
- ☐ Poop bags, a roll on the leash and a box by the door
- ☐ Enzyme cleaner, the big bottle
- ☐ Three chew toys, one of them a Kong
- ☐ Small soft treats, pea-sized
- ☐ Vet picked, first visit booked within the first week
- ☐ Cords moved, shoes in the closet, plants checked
- ☐ Baby gate up at the stairs

Day one

- ☐ First potty trip to the same spot, same word, treat when they go
- ☐ First meal in the crate
- ☐ Collar and leash on for ten minutes inside the house
- ☐ Bedtime in the crate, your worn T-shirt inside, crate next to your bed

Days two to seven

- [ ] Out on waking, after meals, after naps, after play, before bed, every two hours between
- [ ] Three five-minute training sessions a day, starting with sit and come
- [ ] One new sound at low volume during dinner, one new place from a bench
- [ ] First vet visit done, vaccine dates written down, next visit on the calendar
- [ ] Nails checked, ears checked, first brushing done

Want the rest of the month? The full guide — *Puppy's First 30 Days* — covers house training, the vet visits, feeding, socialization, and the rest of the first month, chapter by chapter. Find it at narristotle.com/books/puppy-first-30-days/.

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